MUSICANOTE · Music Search

Melody Search for Libraries That Search by Text

Library databases are built around text such as titles and composers, so a melody alone could not find music. Linking melody-search results to the library database gives members another search route for research and statistics.

How the Search Works

1 Input
On-screen keyboard (C2–E6), rests, durations and metre; paste from a score

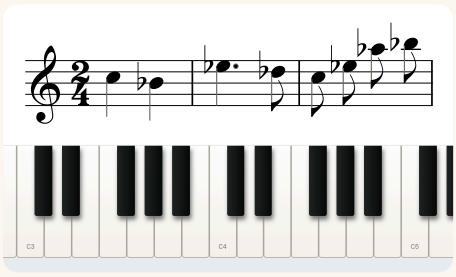
2 Features
Intervals, five-level contour and normalised rhythm, compared separately

3 Candidates
Interval and contour n-gram index narrows the field fast

4 Alignment
Aligned to the metre; small ornaments cost little

5 Results
Match location and sub-scores, with matched notes highlighted

INPUT



8 notes entered on the on-screen keyboard
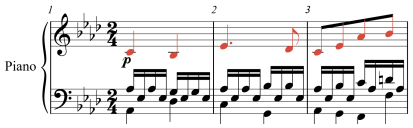
RESULTS

Exact Match — **100** Match Score

Beethoven · Piano Sonata No. 8 "Pathétique", II

1–3 bars · All 5 places the theme appears: bars 1, 9, 29, 51, 59

Interval 100 · Rhythm 97 · Downbeat 31 · Structure 82

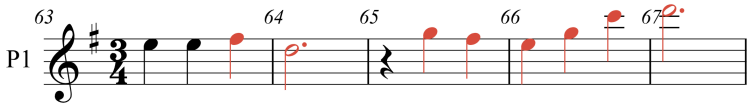


Similar — **92** Match Score

Satie · Je te veux

63–67 bars · A similar melody in another work

Interval 93 · Rhythm 59 · Downbeat 25 · Structure 43



Red notes match the input · Real results from musicanote.com (2026-10-25, melody only)

Library Database Integration

- Scope: over 300,000 searchable music data entries (melody streams, not unique works)
- Results (work, bar position) link to bibliographic and holdings records, configured per institution
- Research: find melodically similar pieces and variants, with match locations and scores as evidence
- Statistics: melody-level results as a basis for counting and analysis

Ways to Compare

- Melody only: the pitch line alone
- Melody + rhythm: pitches and timing together
- Rhythm only, or a contour drawn on screen

Explore the Site

musicanote.com

song@musicanote.com

Beta features · Results are candidates for review · Library integration is configured per institution.

MUSICANOTE